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MINI PLENARY - NATIONAL ASSEMBLY

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PROCEEDINGS OF MINI-PLENARY SESSION OF NATIONAL ASSEMBLY

Members of the mini-plenary session met at Good Hope Chamber at 10:00.

House Chairperson Mr C T Frolick took the Chair and requested members to observe a moment of silence for prayer or meditation.

APPROPRIATION BILL

Debate on Vote No 8 – National Treasury (State Security Agency):

The MINISTER IN THE PRESIDENCY: Hon House Chairperson, the Chairperson of the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence, *in absentia*, members of the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence who are present today, the acting Director-General of the State Security Agency, Ambassador Tony Gab

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Msimanga, the acting Co-ordinator for Intelligence heading the National Intelligence Co-ordinating Committee, Dr Ntandazo Sifolo, the top management of the State Security Agency, SSA, management of the Office for Interception Centres, OIC, representatives of the Office of the Inspector-General of Intelligence, and hon members, the rapidly changing global landscape is not only reshaping the international order but fundamentally challenging longstanding arrangements on security, economic stability, and the role of the state itself.

We are living in an era where threats evolve faster, risks spread wider, and certainty grows thinner. Heightened geopolitical tensions, technological disruptions, cyberthreats, and the transnational nature of organised crime continue to define the security environment confronting nations. Under these conditions, the responsibility placed on the intelligence community has never been greater. The intelligence community is called upon not merely to gather information but to convert information into strategic insight, not merely to anticipate events but to interrupt them. For intelligence without foresight is like a radar without range that remains operational in form but unable to detect the

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dangers approaching the nation. This demands institutions that are agile in thought, focused in conduct, and decisive in action, institutions that can protect the Republic whilst remaining firmly grounded in the Constitution and democratic accountability.

For the State Security Agency to fulfil this responsibility of securing the Republic, we must modernise our systems, strengthen the capacity to anticipate and respond to emerging threats, build the skills and capabilities required for a changing security environment, and, above all, we must decisively act to secure the Republic.

Our most immediate frontier to secure the Republic is through a focused, non-negotiable, and decisive fight against organised crime. Organised crime in South Africa has escalated into a multidimensional and deeply entrenched threat that undermines the country's national security, economic stability, democratic governance, and social cohesion. We are witnessing structured and highly co-ordinated criminal networks that operate systematically for profit through illegal activities. These networks range from local gangs to transnational syndicates and often exploit weaknesses in

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border management, socioeconomic conditions, corruption and state capture risks, international criminal connections, technological systems, and limited law enforcement and co-ordination capacity in some areas.

During the 2025-2026 financial year, the State Security Agency completed a comprehensive, intelligence-led anti-organised crime strategy to focus its operational plans. This strategy prioritises critical pillars such as criminal networks, cartels and syndicate profiling, mapping and monitoring, enhanced disruption and enforcement capabilities, including through multi-agency collaboration and co-operation, increased partnerships with critical role-players, building our technological capabilities, as well as improving the technical ability of our members to stay ahead of evolving criminal tactics.

In the 2026-2027 financial year, the SSA will spare no effort in translating the goals of our anti-organised crime strategy into tangible results. Accordingly, we commit to a strengthened, intelligence-led approach that prioritises the identification of priority syndicates and the co-ordinated deployment of multidisciplinary capabilities to disrupt and

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dismantle criminal networks. The fight against organised crime in South Africa and across the globe is always undermined by the contamination of the criminal justice system.

Since 2021, the National Intelligence Estimate has raised the need to decontaminate the criminal justice system. However, compromised elements within the system have always made it impossible to implement this national intelligence priority. I must take this moment to appreciate the decision by His Excellency President Cyril Ramaphosa to appoint the Madlanga Commission that is bringing to the public the extent of the contamination of the criminal justice system and thus making it slightly difficult for compromised elements to continue to operate.

On our part, the SSA has commenced implementing the state of the nation address directive to re-vet members of the Senior Management Service of the SA Police Service, SAPS, and vet members of metropolitan departments and metropolitan municipalities. This work coincides with our own project of implementing the e-vetting system and reviewing the vetting regulations. The e-vetting system will make it possible for the SSA to undertake large-scale vetting projects. Currently,

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the user acceptance testing on phase one of the e-vetting system has commenced and will be deployed for SAPS and Ekurhuleni metropolitan department vetting in the first quarter of the 2026-2027 financial year. A total of 39 000 files out of 56 000 files dating back to 2018 have been digitised to date. The reviewed vetting regulations are undergoing consultations, with a plan to have them finalised by the end of September 2026.

Two of the critical new provisions of these regulations are worth mentioning: firstly, the provision to refer criminal suspicions to law enforcement for investigations as part of the outcomes of the vetting process; and, secondly, the provision for continuous lifestyle audits for the public sector personnel in strategic positions.

A stable and cohesive society is the bedrock of national security. Violent societal conflicts pose a direct threat to social cohesion, economic stability, and South Africa's international standing. These tensions, when left unchecked, manifest in sporadic outbreaks of violence, community clashes, and heightened polarisation that undermine the very foundations of our constitutional democracy.

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Such conflicts not only endanger lives and destroy livelihoods but also damage investor confidence and disrupt local economies. We are starting to observe the intersection of violent societal conflicts with organised crime and the influence of foreign actors. Of late, South Africa is experiencing a rise in anti-illegal immigration-linked protests that are exploiting the genuine concerns of South Africans about the spiralling illegal immigration problem. These genuine concerns are opportunistically being used by criminal elements, populist agitators, and external actors seeking to destabilise our nation.

In the 2025-2026 financial year, the State Security Agency strengthened its focus on early detection and mitigation of these threats. The SSA will continue to monitor underlying drivers of violent societal conflict, including economic inequality, service delivery failures, unemployment, and inflammatory rhetoric, and provide timely strategic and operational intelligence to relevant government departments and law enforcement agencies to address these challenges.

[Interjections.]

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The HOUSE CHAIRPERSON (Mr C T Frolick): Hon Minister, my ...
[Interjections.] Hon Selepe from the MKP, your microphone is on. Can we just mute that member, please? Please proceed, hon Minister.

The MINISTER IN THE PRESIDENCY: As the lead agency for national security, the SSA remains committed to safeguarding social cohesion without compromising the rights and freedoms enshrined in our Constitution. Our assessment is that South Africans are not xenophobic. Hence, we uphold the constitutional principle that national security must reflect the resolve of South Africans as individuals and as a nation to live as equals, to live in peace and harmony, to be free from fear and want, and to seek a better life.

Hon members, the Intelligence Services recognise that illegal immigration, when exploited by organised criminal syndicates, constitutes not merely a domestic border management challenge but a broader transnational security concern requiring co-ordinated regional and international intelligence co-operation. Where the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime protocol is implemented, South Africa plays a role in upholding that protocol, with South

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African Intelligence Services increasingly engaging foreign intelligence agencies and security counterparts on the need for a co-ordinated continental and regional security response directed not against lawful migration itself but against organised criminal facilitation networks that exploit vulnerable populations, porous borders, corruption vulnerabilities, and weak governance environments for financial and operational gain.

South Africa continues to advocate for enhanced intelligence-sharing mechanisms among regional and continental partners regarding organised migrant smuggling syndicates, trafficking networks, fraudulent documentation systems, illicit financial flows, and transnational criminal facilitators operating across multiple jurisdictions.

The Republic further supports the strengthening of co-operative early warning systems capable of identifying emerging migration security risks, criminal transit corridors, and evolving patterns of cross-border organised criminal activity. South Africa also continues to encourage greater co-operation within the African Union and Southern African Development Community, SADC, continental frameworks regarding

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harmonised border security standards, intelligence fusion mechanisms, and co-ordinated counter-organised crime strategies aligned with the obligations contemplated under the Palermo Convention. Modern terrorism is also increasingly operating through decentralised networks, digital platforms, illicit financial flows, and transnational facilitation systems. This means that counterterrorism today is not only about preventing attacks but also about protecting the integrity of financial systems, strengthening internal co-ordination, and disrupting the financial infrastructure that enables extremist activity.

In the last year, South Africa has shown great progress in strengthening its resilience against and response to countering violent extremism and terrorism. The State Security Agency and other law enforcement agencies have placed specific focus on disrupting and countering terrorist financing and improving institutional co-ordination. This included better inter-agency and interdepartmental collaboration, an increased use of financial intelligence in investigations, and an increase in the detection of terrorism and terrorist financing-related activities in line with the country's risk profile. Noteworthy advancements have been made in this

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regard, such as finalising the comprehensive Terror Financing National Risk Assessment, compiling the National Counter the Financing of Terrorism Strategy, developing and implementing a targeted financial sanctions operational framework regime, improving access to beneficial ownership information, and strengthening the capability and capacity of law enforcement and other role-players in order to effectively detect, investigate, and prosecute terror financing offences.

Today, every aspect of our lives relies on digital systems, which are increasingly vulnerable to malicious actors.

Consequently, nations globally have made cybersecurity a top priority. In South Africa, it is no different. As South Africa's digital economy rapidly transforms and expands, it increases vulnerabilities and provides more entry points for increasingly sophisticated cybercriminals, hackers, and state-sponsored actors.

During our Budget Vote last year, we communicated that we were finalising consultations on the draft national cybersecurity strategies. Considering the feedback from the consultative sessions and the growing number of cyberattacks affecting multiple sectors and causing significant disruptions, it is

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imperative to develop a comprehensive strategy that transcends traditional defensive measures and focuses on resilience. To achieve digital resilience, we are prioritising cyber-resilience, which is the ability to anticipate, withstand, respond to, and recover from cybersecurity incidents.

Intelligence co-ordination is a central pillar to intelligence success. In the 2024-2025 financial year, we finalised and brought into implementation the regulations for intelligence co-ordination, and that effort strengthened the effectiveness of national intelligence structures. This term, we finalised the establishment of the National Centre for Intelligence Co-ordination, NCIC. Since the dawn of democracy, there has only been an office for the National Co-ordinator for Intelligence and the National Intelligence Co-ordinating Committee, NICOC, principals, without a structure to support their work.

In this regard, we have sought to implement the recommendations of the 2006 task team on the review of intelligence-related legislation, regulations, and policies. The task team had recommended that there be a distinction between the Office of the Co-ordinator and the NICOC principals and the staff supporting the work of intelligence

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co-ordination. As such, we have established and launched the National Centre for Intelligence Co-ordination. This body represents the final piece of the puzzle in our quest for a unified national security picture and strategic reforms.

The NCIC serves as the daily integration hub where NICOC, the committee comprising the heads of SAPS, Crime Intelligence, Defence Intelligence, the State Security Agency Intelligence, and the State Security Agency Intelligence Services, regularly meets to synthesise raw data into actionable wisdom for the executive. It is through the full functioning of the NCIC that we are finally breaking down the silos that once allowed organised crime and sabotage to flourish in the gaps between departments. This centre ensures that our response to national threats is no longer reactive but is instead guided by a single, coherent narrative for risks facing our nation.

As we meet today, the National Security Council will soon consider the 2026 National Intelligence Estimate and the National Intelligence Priorities so that they can be implemented. The work of the NCIC and NICOC is pivotal in focusing the attention of our national intelligence structures

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on key intelligence priorities that ought to be addressed in this financial year.

In today's rapidly evolving digital landscape, communications have fundamentally transformed. Criminal networks, organised criminal syndicates, and national security threat actors increasingly operate across encrypted platforms, data-driven applications, and borderless digital environments. These actors continue to exploit advanced technologies to operate with greater sophistication and anonymity. Traditional methods of investigation, lawful interception, and surveillance are therefore no longer sufficient on their own. As a country, we must ensure that our capabilities evolve at the same pace as the threats confronting us.

The operations of the OIC are currently constrained by ageing infrastructure, characterised by challenges relating to reliability, maintenance, scalability, and increasing digital technological obsolescence amid rapid advancements in telecommunications. A similar problem applies to the National Communications Centre. It is therefore imperative that the OIC and the National Communications Centre prioritise the modernisation and strengthening of their interception and

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surveillance capabilities to ensure that law enforcement agencies are equipped with lawful, reliable, and effective tools to fulfil their constitutional mandate. This modernisation will enhance stability, minimise downtime, and establish a sustainable technological environment capable of meeting future operational needs.

Cloud computing is no longer optional. It is essential. The volume, velocity, and variety of data associated with modern communications require a scalable, flexible, and resilient infrastructure. Therefore, the SSA will be investing in robust cybersecurity and data protection measures to make sure that sensitive information remains secure through data-secured platforms, as well as reliable networks and a vibrant and reliable data centre. The financial resources have been appropriately ring-fenced to enable the OIC to respond rapidly to technological changes introduced by electronic communication service providers. Given the dynamic nature of the telecommunications system, the OIC system must remain agile, adaptive, and continuously modern.

It is precisely in this context of our modernisation that, during the 2025-2026 Budget Vote, we reflected extensively on

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the transformation currently under way within the State Security Agency and reaffirmed the commitment of the agency's leadership to implement the recommendations of the high-level review panel as part of the broader programme of renewal and repositioning.

A key priority over the medium term is the implementation of human resource strategies and policies that improve the organisational framework and strengthen alignment between skills and functional requirements across the organisation. This will ensure that skills are aligned to roles in a manner that supports effective delivery of the agency's mandate. This process is being guided by the development of the business model, capability model, operational model, and capacity model, which will provide clarity on what the organisation must deliver, the capabilities required, and how this should be structured and deployed. These models will also inform how technology can be leveraged to enhance specific components of the operational model, enabling improved efficiency, integration, and responsiveness.

In the 2026-2027 financial year, we will prioritise the disestablishment of the State Security Agency and the

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establishment of the SA Intelligence Agency, the domestic service, and the SA Intelligence Service, the foreign service. Work is already under way to prepare for the proclamation, including the articulation of the functions and structures for the reconfigured Intelligence Services, as well as the finalisation of regulations, which are key requirements for the implementation of the General Intelligence Laws Amendment Act.

To support the effective functioning of the civilian services within the allocated resource framework, I have approved the shared service structure, which will provide integrated corporate support services across the intelligence environment. This model will support key legislated entities, including the Office of the Interception Centres, the Office of the Inspector-General of Intelligence, and the newly established National Centre for Intelligence Co-ordination. These institutional reforms are not taking place in isolation. They are being driven by the nature of the threats confronting the Republic today. Chief amongst these is the growing sophistication of organised criminal networks that are increasingly operating across borders and require decisive action on our part.

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Hon House Chairperson, the challenges confronting nation states are not only internal but also arise from external pressures, as both are interrelated and are part of the bigger system. South Africa has not been immune from the effects of contemporary global geopolitical contestation. Indeed, many of the challenges facing our country, the region, and the continent emanate from this fact. The global security environment is undergoing a period of intense geopolitical tensions and conflicts, which threaten and disrupt supply chains and the overall business environment.

South Africa remains a key financier and strategic country in SADC to advance regional integration and cohesion. The region faces a myriad of threats that impedes the advancement of priorities of the Medium-Term Development Plan 2024-2029. Inclusive economic growth and job creation cannot materialise if political instability and conflict in the region continue to exert pressure on South Africa's bilateral relations. As the chair of SADC, South Africa will not only seek to strengthen existing partnerships towards diversifying its trade and commercial relations but will also continue to champion regional integration and industrialisation to advance regional security.

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The State Security Agency continues to closely monitor developments in the north and in the Horn of Africa regions, whose instability carries implications for South Africa's national security. In Sudan, the ongoing civil war and escalating drone attacks have worsened the humanitarian crisis, ongoing displacement, and arms proliferation. Moreover, terror activity as espoused by Al-Shabaab in Somalia, coupled with transnational organised crime, further threaten the Horn of Africa's stability, with an impact on the South African situation and SADC in general.

The situation in the Middle East remains tense due to the longstanding Israeli-Palestinian conflict and a fragile ceasefire between the United States and Iran. In Gaza, violence continues, exacerbating a severe humanitarian crisis and mass displacement. In Iran, the nonresolution of the ceasefire creates a problem for the stability and security of oil supply and therefore the stability of our economies.

The contemporary dynamic and fast-changing landscape in the fields of intelligence and national security has necessitated organisational agility. It has become imperative for the intelligence community, including the SSA, to stay ahead of

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and abreast with technology-induced threats and opportunities, thus the need for technologically inclined intelligence and counterintelligence production.

The evolution of the intelligence environment demands continuous alignment of skills, knowledge, and tools, matching them with ever-changing cutting-edge technologies used by potential adversaries. It is upon this premise that the South African National Intelligence Academy, SANAI, is utilising its convenience to foster business optimisation through the alluded technologically inclined intelligence production. As the Minister in the Presidency, I have directed the agency to help optimise its business by leveraging the power of data. This vision aims to improve strategic decision-making and operational efficiency, amongst others, and thus establishing a data institute through SANAI is of paramount importance. The data institute will then serve as a dedicated hub for research and development and will foster data-driven innovation and develop data capabilities through training and continuous professional development in support of data-related technologies for the intelligence community.

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In order to advance South Africa's national security interests, the data institute as a strategic enabler of SANAI and the SSA will attract and house experts in the fields of data science, cybersecurity, machine learning, and artificial intelligence. These experts will collaborate on complex data challenges, ensuring governance, security, and integrity of data and creating advanced solutions that can transform the SSA's operations across businesses. The geospatial information data dashboard is another innovation intended to help reorientate functions of the organisation towards geospatial technology-inclined intelligence collection, analysis, and dissemination.

Through the academy, the SSA entered into a memorandum of understanding with the SA National Space Agency in 2024, the scope of which makes provision for collaboration in various areas encompassing training and provision of access to other data platforms. This memorandum of understanding is being enhanced to add other functionality. The academy has embarked on a project to register as a higher education institution with the Department of Higher Education, which will also include accreditation with the Council on Higher Education.

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The higher education institution project task team was established, consisting of various experts within the academy and across other structures of the agency. In support of this strategic repositioning, the agency is also strengthening the academy's role as a centre for research, innovation, and future-orientated capability development. I thank you.

The HOUSE CHAIRPERSON (Mr C T Frolick): Thank you, hon Minister. I have allowed you to complete your speech, hon Minister. We will just adjust the time at the end. Thank you very much. The next speaker is the hon Mpapane.

Mrs D E MPAPANE: Hon House Chairperson, hon Minister, the intelligence family, colleagues, I greet you all in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. Thirty years ago, South Africa adopted our Constitution that marked not only the birth of a new democratic order, but the renewal of a nation.

It was a moment in which hope was given legal form, where division was replaced with a shared commitment to dignity, justice, accountability, and where power was placed firmly under the authority of the rule of law. Our Constitution did

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more than establish democratic institutions; it redefined the relationship between the state and its people.

It declared that government exists not above the people, but in service of the people. It enshrined the values of human dignity, freedom, equality, transparency and accountability as the moral and legal foundation of our Republic. It is within this constitutional framework that our intelligence services find both their mandate and their obligation.

Intelligence is not power in itself; it is a solemn responsibility to protect the Republic, defend its sovereignty, safeguard its people, and preserve the constitutional order. As we mark three decades of our Constitution, we are reminded that these principles are not self-sustaining. They require constant stewardship, vigilance and renewal. The Constitution remains our compass not only in times of stability, but especially in the moments of reform and renewal.

We gather at the time when the world is becoming increasingly unstable, interconnected, and unpredictable. Across this loop, we are witnessing rising geopolitical tensions, shifting

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alliances, and the erosion of longstanding security certainties.

Cyber threats now move faster than the legislation can be drafted and implemented. Disinformation spreads faster than truth, and organised crime crosses borders with ease, while the instruments of the state often struggle to keep pace. These are not distant developments. They are realities that shape our national security environment every day.

At home, South Africa faces a growing challenge from organised crime networks that are increasingly sophisticated, deeply embedded and economically destructive. These networks erode the foundation of public trust, weaken institutional governance and threaten the everyday conditions necessary for economic development and social cohesion. It is for this reason that the elevation of organised crime as a national security priority is both necessary and urgent and we support this.

As the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence, we will continue to exercise rigorous oversight of this priority area. We do so not only in fulfillment of our mandate, but in

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recognition of the real and lived impact of these threats on communities across our country. We note the progress made in the development of the anti-organised crime strategy, which represents an important step towards more co-ordinated intelligence-led response to one of the most pressing security challenges of our time.

The transformation and separation of the State Security Agency remain a work of national importance and focused oversight for the committee. The reforms underway, guided by the General Intelligence Law Amendment Act, Gila, are not merely administrative exercises; they represent an effort to restore institutional integrity, rebuild public trust and ensure that intelligence services are aligned with the constitutional values that underpin their work.

The committee acknowledges progress in the development of the critical regulatory frameworks to operationalise Gila, including the shared services regulations and strengthened technologically driven vetting systems designed to protect the integrity of the intelligence services and guard against corruption and potential compromise.

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We also welcome the continued work on the White Paper on Intelligence. It offers an opportunity to reimagine intelligence policy for a democratic era shaped by technological change, global complexity and evolving threats.

The committee notes that the ongoing separation of the State Security Agency, SSA, into the South African Intelligence Services and the South African Intelligence Agency. This process is not about institutional separation alone. It is about clarity of mandate, operational effectiveness and the strengthening of South Africa's intelligence services to anticipate and respond to threats in a coherent manner.

We must acknowledge that transformation of this scale is neither simple nor swift, but it is necessary and driven by demands of the changing security environment and the constitutional duty to ensure that intelligence services are effective, lawful and accountable.

This transformation is taking place under severe financial constraints. Hon Minister, we have been raising this concern of financial constraints within the security cluster departments.

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The reality is that increasing intelligence responsibilities are being carried by institutions whose resources are not growing at the same pace. This tension carries consequences for capabilities, technological advancement and long-term institutional sustainability. National security cannot be built on aspiration alone. It requires sustained investment.

As I conclude, I want to say that the ANC supports this Budget Vote, as tabled by the Minister. Thank you.

Mr J B MTOLO: Hon Chairperson, fellow South Africans, may I switch off my video because of the network conditions where I am?

The HOUSE CHAIRPERSON (Mr C T Frolick): Yes, you may, hon Minister.

Mr J B MTOLO: Hon Chairperson, hon members, fellow South Africans, the MK Party arises today to reject this budget with the contempt it deserves. And before this House attempts to lecture us about constitutional order, let us, in the first place, put the truth on record. Parliament and the Presidency have deliberately delayed the swearing-in of duly designated

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MKP members to this committee for over a month and a half. The official opposition has effectively been held ransom, while democratic representation is manipulated through delay, bureaucracy and political convenience.

That alone tells South Africans everything they need to know about the state of governance in this country. This government fears accountability. It fears scrutiny. It fears oversight. As I speak, I am told the MK Party was not going to be allowed to speak, because it was just thrown in. Hence, I am at home. And nowhere is that fear more visible than in the collapsing state security environment before us today.

State security should be the shield of the Republic. Instead, under this government, it has become one of the greatest symbols of state decay. South Africans are being asked to approve billions for intelligent structures that cannot secure borders, cannot dismantle criminal syndicates, cannot stop corruption, cannot anticipate instability, cannot protect infrastructure, and seemingly, cannot even detect major breaches of national security happening under their noses.

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What exactly are we finding here today? We are clearly not finding intelligence excellence; we are finding failure dressed in secrecy. We are finding incompetence, protected by classification stamps. We are finding a government that wants taxpayers to believe that national security means Parliament must stop asking questions while the country burns.

A serious intelligence state does not wake up after the effects. A serious intelligence state prevents crises before they happen, but these government intelligence structures operate like spectators to national collapse.

Drug cartels have established kingdoms in South Africa, not even networks, but kingdoms. Entire communities are controlled by organised criminal syndicates while ordinary South Africans live behind beggar gates, razor wire and fear. Ports are infiltrated, borders are compromised, townships are flooded with narcotics, young people are being destroyed by drugs while syndicates become wealthier and wealthier and more powerful.

Where is state security? What intelligence is being gathered? What operations are succeeding? What exactly justifies these

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billions? Because the evidence before South Africans is not evidence of a capability, but it is evidence of a captured and weakened one.

If South Africa had a functioning intelligence capability, our borders would not resemble open corridors of undocumented migration, trafficking syndicates, illegal firearms, contraband, and transnational criminal operations.

A sovereign state knows who enters its territory. A sovereign state controls its borders. A sovereign state protects its economic and national interests.

This government does none, none of that. Instead, communities across South Africa are carrying the burden of failed border management while government officials sit comfortable in conferences speaking the language of regional co-operation, when the public itself is bleeding authority.

And then comes the greatest embarrassment of them all - Phala Phala. Millions in foreign currency allegedly entered this country, moved through this country, and set hidden on a farm

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belonging to the President of the Republic, undetected.

Undetected.

South Africans are expected to believe that a state which monitors citizens, tracks financial activity and claims sophisticated intelligence capability somehow failed to detect massive volumes of foreign currency moving within the Republic, leading to the highest office in the land.

There are only two possibilities. Either the intelligence services are completely incompetent, or they knew or chose silence. Both possibilities are devastating, because if millions of foreign currencies can allegedly enter and move through South Africa undetected, at presidential level, then what confidence should South Africans, ordinary South Africans, have in the integrity of our national security systems?

What else enters undetected? What criminal money flows through this country unnoticed? What foreign interests operate freely while the state sleeps? What national security threats are there?

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This is very, very embarrassing. Today, the State Security Agency has become associated less with protecting the Republic and more with ... [Time expired.] ... battle. MK does not support this Budget Vote. Thank you.

Mr N MYBURGH: Hon House Chair, hon members and distinguished guests, on the occasion of this budget debate, as much as we appreciate and acknowledge their work, it will serve us well to reflect frankly on the management and the efficacy of our intelligence services. Firstly, we need to acknowledge that our intelligence services have paid far too high a price for improper political interference, resulting in numerous investigations pointing to gross abuse of power and resources. This is a matter for the record.

This has not only lowered the standing of our intelligence community not only in the eyes of the public but has also severely damaged the ability of our services to contribute effectively towards the goal of a safe, free and prosperous South Africa for all. Years have now passed since the first adverse findings were made against some in our intelligence structures. Yet, no evidence has thus far been produced of any meaningful consequence management for serious wrongdoing.

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As I did a year ago, I again today pose the following question to this House: Has anyone to date been reported to any law enforcement agency, or charged, in relation to the disappearance of the State Security Agency, SSA, firearms, or the hundreds of millions of rands found by the Zondo Commission to have been wrongfully withdrawn and handled by Mrs Thulani Dlomo, Mr David Mahlobo – now Deputy Minister – and Arthur Fraser? Of course, the political masters maintain a deafening silence, hoping that the people will forget.

South Africa's societal and economic wellbeing, as well as the authority of the state is increasingly under threat, not from foreign actors, but instead self-inflicted through poor policy decisions, and even poorer governance. For instance, our economy is stagnating, Sub-Saharan Africa and our neighbours are growing at 4,5% while we are seating at 1%, resulting in rising poverty levels and a cost-of-living crisis directly due to poor policy decisions and ineffective governance.

Also, service delivery protests, often violent and destructive, shows no sign of abating. In addition, the scourge of corruption, much talked-about these days but very seldom acted upon, continues to undermine the electorate's

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belief in the preferential nature of a democratic political system. The danger is real because when you continue to vote, year after year, but never see corrupt politicians and crooked officials go to jail, you come to the conclusion that voting is irrelevant and you start looking at other options to express yourself. This is the danger.

To add insult to injury, five years after the riots of July 2021 we still have no credible assurances that the intelligence failures associated with it have been properly addressed properly at all. What did the President of the Republic say about all of this? The President told the Human Rights Commission that the riots destroyed two million jobs and wiped R50 billion off the economy. Let me repeat that. Two million jobs and R50 billion wiped off the economy.

The President also told the commission that the state failed in its duty to detect, and then to quash the unrest, which was of course nothing but an attempted insurrection by the Zuma faction of the ANC. Still, no one got fired and of course, no one resigned.

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To illustrate the severity of the crisis in intelligence we only have to note the following. We have an Inspector-General of Intelligence effectively removed from office, with no prospect of a successor in the foreseeable future. We have an Acting Director-General of State Security, who has been in an acting role for as long as I can remember. We also have an Acting Co-ordinator of Intelligence, critical a role as that is. In fact, we have various acting senior managers across the service. We have a new Intelligence Act, crucial for restructuring and improving South Africa's intelligence services, but deliberately not being implemented. To compound the crisis further, we have shrinking budgets, making it increasingly difficult for our Intelligence Services to meet their constitutional obligations towards the Republic.

The conclusion appears inescapable. We are looking at a clear dereliction of duty amongst those who bear political responsibility for our services. This is not alarmist rhetoric but a clarion call to get our act together, because unless we act with purpose and far greater urgency to fix education, grow the economy with the right policies, restore law and order, and send crooked politicians and officials to jail, our intelligence services will be reduced to passive onlookers,

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unable to stem the tide of societal upheaval and the collapse of our democratic constitutional order. May we never see that day. I thank you.

Ms S GCILISHE: Hon House Chair, this is what we know about state security today. We know that organised criminal syndicates have infiltrated elements of South African criminal justice system, including the intelligence community. We know that there has been a systematic weakening of South Africa's state security apparatus over the past 10 to 15 years because of instability in leadership, corruption and the looting of secret funds to finance luxurious lifestyles and political patronage. We also know that this weakening has produced nepotism, factionalism, and the employment of incompetent operatives who spend more time protecting political interests than protecting the Republic.

The instability within the office of the Inspector General of Intelligence is itself deliberate. Political leadership does not want an independent oversight institution capable of exposing corruption, abuse of secret funds, and unlawful intelligence operations. They want intelligence structures that operate without accountability so that they can be

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weaponised to settle political scores, manipulate internal factional battles, and influence conferences within the governing party.

We have heard evidence during the ad hoc committee that intelligence structures have increasingly drawn into factional political warfare instead of defending the sovereignty and security of South Africa. Deputy Ministers instructing state security intelligence officers and collecting evidence themselves as if they are not political leadership. Even the blocking of the Inspector General of Intelligence from appearing before the ad hoc committee on the allegations raised by General Mkhwanazi was malicious and deeply dishonest. It was a deliberate abuse of parliamentary rules while refusing to find practical arrangements that would have protected legitimate state security concerns without undermining oversight.

The President and the Minister prioritise protecting the governing party and shielding corruption over protecting the integrity of Parliament and restoring confidence in the intelligence services. They want to continue weaponising intelligence structures and secret funds for narrow political

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gain. State security secrets are leaked without consequences. Secret funds are looted without consequences. Intelligence assets disappear without trace and later emerge in private bank accounts and properties registered in people's names. Parliament itself admits that it is failing to exercise meaningful oversight over intelligence structures, while the Auditor-General cannot properly audit intelligence expenditure because everything is hidden behind secrecy and classification.

The EFF maintains that as long as South Africa does not have a coherent national economic security strategy, intelligence structures will remain disjointed, corrupt and internally compromised. State security cannot be about spying on politicians and protecting factions within the governing party while organised crime captures institutions of the state, illegal mining syndicates expand, drug cartels operate across borders, and foreign interests undermine the sovereignty of South Africa.

We are witnessing transnational criminal networks co-ordinating themselves better than South African state itself. Intelligence services must protect the people and sovereignty

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of South Africa, not factional political interest. The EFF therefore believes that the following must happen urgently.

Firstly, South Africa must develop a national economic security strategy that links intelligence work to industrial policy, cybersecurity, border security, energy security, and financial sovereignty. Secondly, there must be a complete lifestyle audit, vetting review of all senior intelligence officials, including a full investigation into the abuse of secret services accounts and intelligence slash funds. Thirdly, Parliament must establish a far stronger and genuinely independent oversight mechanism over intelligence structures with protected investigative capacity and the ability to hold the executive accountable without political interference. Fourthly, South Africa must professionalise the intelligence community through proper training merit-based recruitment and removal of factional patronage networks. Lastly, there must be consequences. Those who looted intelligence resources, compromised national security and turned intelligence structures into factional battles must be criminally prosecuted and permanently removed from public office.

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The security of the Republic cannot be sacrificed for corruption, incompetence and factional politics. We reject this budget, but before I step down, we encourage all young people to go out and register to vote for the EFF so that we can attain economic freedom in our lifetime.

IsiZulu:

Inkosi R N CEBEKHULU: Ngibonge ithuba, Sihlalo weNdlu, ...

English:

... South Africa has a complex history with state security. In the past, such organisations were used as tools of oppression to isolate and target communities. Today, the State Security Agency, SSA, is committed to reforming its legacy by protecting the welfare of all citizens. It plays an essential role in guarding our nation and keeping South Africa safe from both internal and external threats. However, we must ensure that we do not revert to the fear and anxiety that governed previous state security regimes. Citizens must not be intimidated by the unknown workings of the National Security Agency, NSA, particularly when it is the people's taxes that fund them. For this reason, we call for increased transparency around the financial workings of the State Security Agency. We

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are deeply aware that much of the agency's business must, by nature of its work, remain clandestine. However, this does not mean it is exempt from the rigorous vetting and monitoring to which other government bodies are subject. Without sufficient governmental oversight, it becomes far too easy for financial exploitation to thrive.

IsiZulu:

Ubufakazi balokho, Sihlalo, umlando ukukhombile ukusebenza kabi kwezobunhloli zisebenzisa izimali kabi. Lapho khona abaphethe bebezisiza kanye nemindeni yabo bethi amalungu emindeni ayizimpimpi kanti kwakuyindlela yokukhipha imali kaHulumeni.

English:

We acknowledge that Programme 2 has been allocated billions for the current fiscal year. This programme encompasses both the State Security Agency and the Financial Intelligence Centre. The IFP welcomes this funding, as it indicates a commitment to enhancing the state's capacity to combat financial crime. However, we urge the Treasury to consider implementing practical steps that will increase the amount of oversight that the State Security Agency is subject to. Two

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bodies are currently informed of the State Security Agency's activities to a limited extent, namely the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence and the Office of the Inspector General. This does not leave any space for public scrutiny or comment, which is at odds with our government's commitment to transparent democratic governance.

The IFP's priority has always been to ensure that reason is the guiding principle behind governance. We cannot reconcile the lack of transparency surrounding the state security's budget with our government's commitment to remaining accountable to its public. The IFP supports Budget Vote 8 but strongly urges the Treasury to take practical action in making the financial workings of the State Security Agency more accessible to the public. I thank you.

Afrikaans:

Me J A BASSON: Agb Voorsitter, die PA staan vandag ter ondersteuning van Begrotingspos 8, maar ondersteuning beteken nie dat ons gaan stilbly oor die ernstige probleme binne die State Security Agency [Staatsveiligheidsagentskap] nie.

English:

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South Africans deserve a State Security Agency that protects the people, not politics, corruption and a connected few.

Afrikaans:

Die Staatsveiligheidsagentskap speel 'n kritieke rol in die beskerming van ons land teen georganiseerde misdaad, terrorisme, kubermisdaad en korrupsie. Maar die publiek se vertroue word vernietig deur aanhoudende berugte van onreëlmatige besteding, swak bestuur en politieke inmenging.

Ons mense sit sonder werk. Families sukkel om kos op die tafel te sit en misdaad ruk gemeenskappe uitmekaar. Daarom moet elke sent wat aan veiligheid toegeken word, reg gebruik word, nie vermors word, misbruik word of gesteel word nie.

Die PA vra vandag vir sterker finansiële toesig en aanspreeklikheid, deeglike ondersoek na korrupsie en wanadminstrasie, gevolgbestuur teen amptenare wat skuldig bevind word aan wangedrag, minder politieke inmenging en meer fokus op die veiligheid van Suid-Afrikaners, sterker implimentêre toesig om deursigtigheid en goeie bestuur te verseker.

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English:

Chairperson, supporting this Budget Vote must go hand-in-hand with clean governance, professionalism and integrity.

Afrikaans:

Die mense van Suid-Afrika verdien veiligheidsinstellings wat professioneel, eerlik en verantwoordelik optree, instellings wat die mense dien, nie politieke agendas beskerm nie.

Die PA ondersteun Begrotingspos 8, maar ons eis hervoriming, aanspreeklikheid en 'n agentskap wat weer die vertroue van die publiek kan terugwen.

English:

It is time illegal foreigners are sent home. The procedures are far too lengthy. Our people, the poor of the poor, are losing their jobs, their livelihoods by the day.

IsiZulu:

Abahambe!

English:

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Is not just a slogan, it's a reality. Every foreigner in this country takes a job from a South African, bread from a South African, and food from a South African.

Afrikaans:

Kom ry saam met my deur Bishop Lavis, kom ry saam met my deur Khayelitsha, kom ry saam met my waar ons as Huis die mense van Suid-Afrika teleurstel. Hierdie instansie het die geleentheid om ...

IsiZulu:

... abahambe, ...

Afrikaans:

... 'n realiteit te maak.

English:

Get the foreigners out of our country, and give South Africans their dignity, lives and jobs back. I thank you.

Ms D E JAMES: Hon Chairperson, the State Security Agency is meant to be a shield that protects our democracy, our Constitution, and the people of South Africa from threats both

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inside and outside our borders. Instead, South Africans have watched an intelligence structure plagued by scandal, political interference, and a complete collapse in public trust.

Afrikaans:

So kan dit nie aangaan nie.

English:

At a time when organised crime syndicates are growing stronger, illegal mining networks are expanding, extortion mafias are terrorising communities, and corruption continues to hollow out the state. Our intelligence service should be focused, professional, and effective. Yet year after year, we hear more about infighting, suspensions, allegations, and dysfunction than about successful intelligence operations that keep South Africans safe. South Africans are losing confidence in the broader criminal justice system. Senior SA Police Service officials continue to face arrests, suspensions, and serious allegations of corruption and misconduct. Instead of stability and professionalism at the highest levels of law enforcement, there is constant turmoil. This creates the

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perception that crime syndicates are becoming more organised than the very institutions meant to fight them.

How can ordinary South Africans feel safe when senior officials entrusted with enforcing the law are themselves under investigation? How can communities trust the state when political battles and internal power struggles appear to take priority over public safety? The reality is that when intelligence structures fail, gang violence flourishes in our communities, illegal firearms continue flowing across our borders, drug syndicates expand their reach, critical infrastructure is sabotaged, and ordinary citizens are left vulnerable while criminals operate with growing confidence. The SSA cannot continue to operate under a cloud of secrecy without proper parliamentary oversight and consequence management. Intelligence structures must serve the country, not political factions or personal interests. We need properly skilled intelligence professionals, stronger vetting systems, and modern capabilities to combat cybercrime, organised crime, and financial crimes. We also need far stronger co-ordination between the SSA, the SAPS, the Hawks, and other law enforcement agencies if we are serious about restoring law and order. Most importantly, we must be accountable.

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South Africans are tired of hearing about commissions, investigations, and damning reports with little consequences for those responsible. Public trust cannot be rebuilt while wrongdoing is ignored or protected. The people of South Africa deserve intelligence and law enforcement institutions that are credible, ethical, and capable of protecting them. Until that happens, crime will continue to flourish, corruption will continue to thrive, and public confidence in the state will continue to erode. Again, I say, ...

Afrikaans:

So kan dit nie aangaan nie.

English:

I thank you.

Mr T B MUNYAI: House Chairperson, hon Minister, hon members and the leadership of the services, I must say from the outset that those that were speaking who are not members of the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence, JSCI, were speaking rhetoric or hogwash trying to disinform South Africa. Their speeches must be rejected. They know what they need to do to become members.

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House Chairperson, allow me from the outset to salute men and women of our intelligence services, not with empty rhetoric, but with pride, deep respect and recognition of their sacrifice and unparalleled patriotism. Through close co-operation amongst these agencies, they have shown time and again that they are equal to the task. Effective intelligence enables the state to anticipate its threat before they become crisis. These are men and women who serve in our intelligence service to carry out significant responsibilities under the demanding conditions often without public recognition. Their contribution to national security deserves both the institutional support and sustained strategic investment. We have no doubt that they will continue to fulfil their mandate effectively and professionally in full accordance with the Constitution and in service of the expectation of the JSCI and the people of South Africa.

They do not march in public parade, their names do not appear in headlines, their families do not often know where they go or what they witness as they've proven again time and again that they are equal to the task. They are alive to internal and external threats as they disrupted the gang violence, illicit mining networks, criminals syndicate of the organised

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crime and drugs cartel. They track the cross-border terrorist activities. And they can see the encroachment of our sea, land and airspace. This is not girls' work, but professionalism and patriotism in action. We note that they serve the Constitution and they don't serve anyone else, but the democratic state and the people of South Africa. To underscore the intelligence capability cannot be rebuilt overnight. They require sustained intervention.

We welcome the Cabinet's approval of the Defence Strategy, the journey to greatness, precisely because it will be the enabler to mobilise resources to fund the Defence intelligence and to ensure that it strengthens their operational capabilities required and also the product they need for their professional work.

The General Intelligence Laws Amendment Act was a watershed act precisely because it builds the legal and operational foundation for all domains that are now critical and central to modern warfare, that is, cybersecurity, protection of the information infrastructure, the dedicated cyber command and artificial intelligence domain. For Defence intelligence, these are not optional addition. They are a nerve centre or

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the very same brain that our intelligence service, operational capacity and efficiencies requires. Therefore, the General Intelligence Laws Amendment Act is the basis for our digital arteries. No structure of offensive or defensive warfare can be able to advance without cyber warfare or artificial intelligence, AI, as symmetry predictive threat analysis.

I must say that we are acknowledging the recovery and it will not be immediate. Financial pressures have been the genesis for Defence intelligence. Therefore, they are operating under those weaknesses. As I said earlier, we are looking forward for them to rebuild their capabilities to make sure that the strategic in-depth of technological modernisation, digitisation, infrastructure renewal and retention of the scarce and specialised skills.

I must say that the committee remains equally committed to ensure that there is accountability, efficiency, sound governance and measurable outcomes within the Defence intelligence. Every allocation must contribute towards the meaningful rebuilding of operational capabilities, improving readiness, strengthen analytical capacity and remain focused in conducting focused oversight.

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The committee therefore expect a continued progress in addressing the critical capabilities to make sure that they have resources to strengthen the product that they need to operate in the current ever evolving environment. Modern intelligence work requires specialised expertise across the range of disciplines, including cyber capabilities, data analysis, strategic forecasting, language capabilities, technological system and regional security analysis. Without adequate investment. [Time expired.] We support this Budget Vote unconditionally and unequivocally. Thank you.

Mrs N L HLAZO-WEBSTER: House Chairperson, I was asked in an interview yesterday about the significance of South Africa's institution. My response was that the Constitution survives not simply because it is written on paper, but because we strengthen and protect the institutions that are safe, that are entrusted with safeguarding it. And that's why the budget that we are debating today matters. This budget is ultimately about whether South Africa can rebuild a professional intelligence capability that protects the Republic, one that safeguards the Constitution and contributes to economic stability, or whether we continue to find institutions that

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are weakened by political infiltration and institutional decay.

This budget allocates over R5 billion for State Security Agency operations. Alongside that is additional allocations for machinery and equipment with the secret services environment.

But it is not just budgets that rebuild legitimacy. The High-Level Review Panel on the State Security Agency was very clear that South Africa must rebuild a professional national intelligence capability that is grounded in constitutional principles. Yet, over many years, intelligence structures were diverted away from constitutional accountability, and they were drawn into factional politics, abuse of power and institutional manipulation. The problem is that when intelligence institutions become politicised, the consequences extend far beyond the security sector because intelligence and economic stability are directly connected. You cannot have an economy that thrives where organised crime can infiltrate ports, procurement systems, infrastructure and state institutions. There is no investor that has confidence in a

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state whose intelligence capability is compromised by internal factionalism and weakened institutional capacity.

The July 2021 unrest exposed this reality, and it did so in the most devastating way. There were more than 300 people that lost their lives. We saw supply chains collapsed. There were businesses destroyed that to this day have not been able to reopen and have not been restored. There is strategic economic infrastructure that was disrupted. We saw similar vulnerabilities during the cyber attack on Transnet which exposed weaknesses in protecting infrastructure that is vital to economic activity.

The White Paper on Intelligence already envisioned intelligence services that are politically neutral, that are constitutionally grounded and that are accountable to Parliament. That is why the reforms matter in as much as we can talk about budget and allocations today. The reforms matter for stronger parliamentary oversight, for investigations into abuses of power, for protections against illegal orders and for rebuilding professional intelligence capacity. Those are not merely administrative reforms. They

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are constitutional reforms and they are necessary to restore legitimacy of the ... [Time expired.]

Ms D KOHLER-BARNARD: Chairperson, we are living in interesting times. Unfortunately, the phrase is traditionally considered an ancient Chinese curse, referring to a tumultuous period. However, make no mistake: this is not a curse from ancient China, and we are not victims of fate, but victims of a system that has learned to weaponise secrecy. Throughout the South African Police Service, Saps, the never-ending arrests have reached the highest ranks.

On Wednesday, the suspended National Police Commissioner stood in the dock alongside the underworld figure Vusimuzi "Cat" Matlala, together with twelve other officers. Who would ever have thought we would see such a day? All of this relates to the questionable Medicare 24 contract.

We have now witnessed the entire top structure of crime intelligence being arrested. Despite all attempts to downplay the seriousness of the situation by claiming it was merely a human resources matter, the charges are fraud and corruption. There are always two sides to such claims: the arrests

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themselves versus the assertion that this is part of an internal power struggle. We have just seen the arrest of Major General Feroze Khan, the head of Saps counterintelligence, in Gauteng. He is accused of involvement in an illicit precious metal syndicate, corruption, and defeating the ends of justice.

Major General Ebrahim Ahmed Kadwa, the head of the Directorate for Priority Crime Investigation, the Hawks) in Gauteng, was arrested alongside him, together with senior crime intelligence officers, all linked to the illegal possession of R286 000 worth of gold dust. The key question is: who conducted their top-secret security clearance vetting? Did they actually undergo the process? It appears that many have not. Is this an example of the vetting system being undermined, sidelined, or simply ignored? In that context, it is inconceivable that I must ask whether all those in top positions, including those serving the Minister, even possess top-secret security clearance. We need those assurances, because individuals in such positions without clearance are clearly a threat to national security.

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Public confidence in crime intelligence, and in the South African Police Service as a whole, has fallen to a level not seen since former National Police Commissioner Jackie Selebi was jailed and former Crime Intelligence head Richard Mdluli was arrested. Mdluli still faces court proceedings over allegations of large-scale looting after serving time in prison for a separate murder-related matter.

The much-attacked National Prosecuting Authority, NPA,'s investigating directorate against corruption is amongst many other focus areas, leading the charge in an effort to cleanse the police service as a whole. Of course, we see a predictably huge fight back there. Then add to the messy mix the bizarre suspension of the Inspector-General of Intelligence, Imtiaz Fazel, appointed on 01 November 2022, now sitting at home with his office at a standstill since October.

If there was ever a time when this country needed an Inspector General of Intelligence to be at work, it would be now. But his suspension was as predictable as was the suspension of his predecessor. The pattern is clear, suspend the watchdog, then complain that no one is watching.

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Now, the focus has quite rightly been turned to members of Parliament, claiming a failure in the oversight process, just as they in the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence of the Fifth Parliament were blamed for failing to even notice, let alone uncover, the mass looting going on from both the State Security Agency and Crime Intelligence at that time.

The 2019 High-Level Review Panel report on the State Security Agency, SSA, found that systemic secrecy was used to conceal criminality, political factionalism, and serious financial mismanagement. At the time, the SSA treated secrecy as a shield, disregarding regulations to hide illicit activities, which were then classified. The secrecy was so pervasive that holding officials accountable became nearly impossible.

Thankfully, the SSA today seems infinitely more focused, as one of the finest brains trusts and threat analysis teams, which work together, surely amongst the best in the world. Never again will a politician, as was the case in the past, simply give an order for the SSA staff to fabricate a report on non-existent evidence, or use it for political gain. It is inconceivable and immoral.

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One is to ask whether Crime Intelligence has not learned from the SSA's old guard tactics. One is compelled to ask if they are ignoring certain regulations as irrelevant in the face of their mandate. What could be hidden as potential theft, fraud, and corruption, or not, I do not know, I do not think anyone will ever know. We are waiting for the day when so many of these matters hitting the headlines eventually go to court, and we will find out where those hundreds of millions of rands went. Again, one is compelled to ask if that may ever happen.

We have seen every entity or individual who tried to expose internal criminality being ridiculed, attacked, or arrested. On a more positive note, the intelligence sector is undergoing significant reform, driven by the Zondo Commission and the High-Level Review Panel report. The General Intelligence Laws Amendment Act, which we worked intensively to process last term, should bring about far-reaching change. The SSA is set to be dissolved and replaced by a Foreign Intelligence Service and a Domestic Intelligence Agency, as was the case before the Zuma years. That is the plan, although whether it will happen sooner rather than later remains to be seen.

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In addition, there is increased transparency in intelligence strategy. Finally, it seems to me that this entire sector may well be moving in the right direction, and the country should feel safer for it - a lot safer than during the riots, when there was no intelligence at all, or Saps for that matter. Thank you.

IsiXhosa:

Mnu. M DLELANGA: Sihlalo weNdlu ohloniphekileyo, ndivumele ndithi, ngqanga neentsiba zayo. Kwabasithelweyo ndithi, iinkosi mazithambe izicaka zizolile. Ngamafutshane, ndiyabulisa ...

English:

Minister, hon members, from the outset the ANC fully supports this budget Vote. In doing so, we call for additional resources to ensure our people are protected and can live freely in our country. In communities across South Africa, millions of our people continue to live with the daily reality of crime and insecurity. Families lock themselves behind gates and blocker bars, not because they feel safe, but because fear has become part of ordinary life. Communities live under the threat of gang violence, extortion, kidnappings, drug

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trafficking, illegal mining, infrastructure theft, and organised crime networks that continue to operate within growing suffocation and alarming wildness.

These crimes do not occur in isolation. They are co-ordinated, they are organised, they are well financed, and increasingly difficult to combat through traditional policing methods alone. And when communities ask how criminal syndicates continue to operate within such impunity, the question they are actually asking is this, where is intelligence? Because effective policing in the modern era depends not only on visible policing, but on the strength, credibility, and effectiveness of crime intelligence.

Crime intelligence remains central to the fight against organised crime, violent criminality, corruption, sabotage, and threats to public safety.

One of the most critical areas that requires continued attention is integrity management. The committee agrees with the Minister that integrity must become a non-negotiable foundation of crime intelligence. Officials entrusted with intelligence responsibilities occupy positions of enormous

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sensitivity and trust. They must therefore meet the highest standards of professionalism, ethical conduct, and security competence.

As the ANC, we are making a call for immediate standardisation and implementation of the rotation strategy or plan to all agencies based on poor performance, based on the lack of top security clearance, and unethical behaviour. We believe that it will contribute to safeguarding our country and making sure that integrity, conduct, and the way of work become non-negotiable.

I must say that crime intelligence remains central to fighting crime. The recent dismantling of major clandestine drug laboratories in Mpumalanga and the North West demonstrates the critical value of intelligence-led policing in the fight against organised crime. These operations, which led to the seizure of drugs and manufacturing equipment worth hundreds of millions of rand, were not accidental successes but the result of co-ordinated work by crime intelligence and specialised law enforcement units acting on gathered intelligence, surveillance, and operation analysis.

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They reflect a growing capacity of intelligence structures to detect and disrupt sophisticated criminal syndicates operating within our borders. The work of rebuilding this capability is not simply about institutional reform. It is about restoring public trust. It is about ensuring that communities feel protected. It is about strengthening the ability of a democratic state to fulfil its basic responsibilities, the safety and security of its people. The community, therefore, will continue to exercise firm oversight over reforms, governance, institutional capacity, accountability, and effective use of public resources within crime intelligence.

There are areas that need to be clarified yet, because at the beginning you can see the confusion, but at the end there shall be clarity. Hon Mtolo from the MK Party, is lying here, and all you must know is that lies have short legs. To those who say this budget, they must know that they are rejecting it with the protection of our people... [Interjections.] ...

THE CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Hon member, will you please take a seat? What is your point of order?

Mr W M DOUGLAS: My point of order is that the member on the podium has said that our member, hon Mtolo, is lying. You can

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look under eighty-five, you can look under 87, 93, any one of them. He is casting aspersions upon our members specifically. So, please rule on that, hon Chairperson.

THE CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Thank you very much, hon member. Hon Langa, will you please withdraw?

Mr M DLELANGA: In withdrawal, I can say that is economical from the truth on our behalf, sir. Thank you so much.

Mr S NOMVALO: No withdraw!

Mr W M DOUGLAS: You must withdraw without any conditions.

THE CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Hon member, will you please withdraw unconditionally?

Mr M DLELANGA: There are no conditions I withdraw, but the truth is not in terms of the people.

Mr S NOMVALO: No, withdraw, sir. Come back and withdraw.

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THE CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Hon member, I did not give you an opportunity to do a point of order. Hon member?

Mr W M DOUGLAS: Can we just note that it is an unconditional withdrawal, please. There must be no conditions, no side notes, and any aside sayings. You must withdraw. What you said was wrong and it is against the rules. Thank you.

THE CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Hon Dlelanga did withdraw what he said. The next speaker is the Minister in the Presidency.

The MINISTER IN THE PRESIDENCY (Ms K P S Ntshavheni): Hon House Chair, I would like to take this opportunity to thank the members of the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence for their continued support and their non-partisan oversight, which is very robust. It is very clear from members who are not members of the committee that they will rely on gossip, on rumours, on mistruth and misinformation.

I would like to clarify to the House that there is no member of my staff who does not possess a top security clearance certificate. I also want to make it clear to the House and

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South Africans who are listening that nobody has delayed the vetting of MKP members. The MKP delays its own members. As soon as we finalise their vetting, they withdraw the member. So, instead of voting other senior officials, we continue to be vetting members of MKP.

I do not know why hon Mtolo will want to talk about the virtues of things that he is misinformed about when his own party sold young people to Russia to become mercenaries, and we are asking: Where were the intelligence services ...

[Interjections.]

The CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Will you please take a seat? There is a point of order. Hon member, what is your point of order?

Mr W M DOUGLAS: My point of order is that the Minister is misleading the House. There was under no circumstances that anyone in the MKP had sold anybody to Russia. This is completely fallacy and it needs to be ... [Interjections.]

Thank you.

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The CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Hon member, that is not a point of order. Hon Deputy Chief Whip!

Mrs D E MPAPANE: Chairperson, I don't think it is assisting this House to just call for a point of order without quoting the rule. So, we take that as a frivolous point of order. Whenever a member calls for a point of order, they must quote the rule on which they are standing on. Thank you.

The CHAIRPERSON (Ms C Labuschagne): Thank you very much, Deputy Chief Whip. The point of order that was raised was not a point of order; it was a point of debate. It is the rule in the House that when you raise on a point of order, you actually should quote the rule on which you raise. Minister, you may continue, please.

The MINISTER IN THE PRESIDENCY (Ms K P S Ntshavheni): Thank you. So, where was the intelligence services he was asking about? They were busy returning the young men and women who were sold to Russia safely back into the country. We must remind their parents that the MKP also sold their children.
[Interjections.]

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When refusing to give credit, where credit is due in the speech, that characterises hon Myburgh's address. Knowing fully well the progress that has been made and acknowledging it, he decides to go and dig the past from which we are not proud of and from which we have been focused systematically to address in the intelligence structures.

My dear friend, hon Gcilishe, which intelligence service were you talking about? This is because we have not had leaks in the intelligence service until the friends of other people that I will not mention by name were in - since the friends of other people who were in the intelligence services left the service. Hon Myburgh, perhaps we must ask my friends this other side to find Mr Thulani Dlomo for us.

The National Security Strategy, hon Gcilishe, was approved in 2024-25. Our APP and our strategic plan is informed by the National Security Strategy and the National Intelligence Priorities continuously. We have been there, so maybe we need to find a member in that one. The SSA does not have a slash fund; neither does it have a secret service. This goes also to hon Hlazo-Webster, that our account is run by the National Treasury, just so that people can know.

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Hon Cebekhulu, we appreciate your concerns. However, to open up intelligence services for public transparency will weaken the national security of the country. However, we have instituted measures to make sure that there is transparency to the oversight community. Currently, we are institutionalising those measures through the regulations on financial management and financial accountability, on which will work closely with the committee. We have also undertaken that will submit those before end of this financial year to the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence.

Hon Basson, we are also pleased to know that the concerns that you have raised are a thing of the past; they were long outdated. However, we can't say foreigners are not allowed in South Africa. Of concern, it is only illegal undocumented foreign nationals. In my speech, I have indicated the measures we are undertaking to make sure that we secure our borders but also deal with illegal migration. We also want to ensure that the deportation of the people who are in the country undocumented means that they have left the country.

I have reiterated in all my speeches - the Budget Vote speeches - that: We have got 55 000 refugees in the country;

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and we have got 82 000 asylum seekers in the country. That number is not a threat, and they are allowed to stay here because they have been granted a stay and comply with our rules.

I have never seen a member cast suspicion to other Members of Parliament. Hon Adams says the Joint Standing Committee on Intelligence, which is multi-party and nonpartisan, is very weak. I do not know why she is not a member herself.

Hon Kohler, you ask a question that you have an answer to. You know who voted the SA Police Service leadership. You also know why the President requested the revetting of the SA Police Service by SSA. This is because we have got confidence in that process. I have spoken about the reinforcement of our regulations to make sure that we are up to scratch, and also, we do countermeasures to make sure that those who are criminals within the SA Police Service can be arrested by referring to their criminal activities.

We have confidence in our system, and we are bringing in the vetting of other agencies, including the request by the Minister of Justice and Constitutional Development regarding

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the vetting of prosecutors. That work is work at hand. Perhaps
I must ask: Why are you no longer a member of the committee?
[Time expired.] Thank you.

Debate concluded.

The mini plenary session rose at 11:40.